

ARX LUMINA (The Real-Life Game)

Character Creation Guide, 2nd Edition

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ILLUSTRATIONS

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1. WELCOME

This is a quick reference for creating arx lumina characters. Here you will find tables for setting up the characters backstory and progression.

This quick reference replaces Chapters 3 to 5 of the original "Arx Lumina Gamemaster Guide" (1st ed.).

The rules are based on the Fate Core Rulebook (<https://fate-srd.com/fate-core>).

The quick reference tables are inspired by the following RPG resources:

- "Backgrounds & Details Kit V2", Emead Games
- "GURPS Light 4th Ed", Steve Jackson Games
- "Traveller Core Rulebook", Marc Miller

Ideas from those resources have been considered while creating the tables for the arx lumina setting.

The quick reference does not provide any suggestions on how to gather real life experience points (further on rl-xps).

2. FATE CORE MATH

Fate Core is based on the "Fate Roll". Roll 4 D6 and add the results as follows:

-
-
-

This yields the following probability distribution for the Fate Roll:

Result	Odd of rolling	Odd of rolling this or higher
-4	1.23%	100%
-3	4.94%	98.77%
-2	12.35%	93.83%
-1	19.75%	81.48%
0	23.46%	61.73%
+1	19.75%	38.27%
+2	12.35%	18.52%
+3	4.94%	6.17%
+4	1.23%	1.23%

When it comes to skill tests, Fate Core refers to "The Ladder" for judging the outcome:

Result	Description
+8	Legendary
+7	Epic
+6	Fantastic
+5	Superb
+4	Great
+3	Good
+2	Fair
+1	Average
0	Mediocre
-1	Poor
-2	Terrible

3. CHARACTER BACKSTORY

3.1 ARX LUMINA SPECIFIC RULES

Consider the following points when playing in the arx lumina setting:

- The character is a "functional". He/she can use artifacts. Characters start with "functional + 1". Every artifact has a "complexity level". When using an artifact actively, roll against that level with you functional skill.
- Advantages replace Character Stunts. Stunts are only provided as artifact effects.



3.2 FAMILY

-	Profession / Situation
-4	Slave
-3	Refugee/Exile
-2	Criminal
-1	Servant
0	Craftsman/-woman

-	Profession / Situation
+1	Farmer
+2	Merchant
+3	Cleargy
+4	Upper Class

You can spent 5 rl-xps to alter the result by +/-1. Do this only once. The family situation affects your starting resources and the social status.

Next roll on the siblings table:

	Silbings
-4 to -2	no siblings
-1	one sibling
0 to +1	two siblings
+2	twin birth (same or opposite sex)
+3 to +4	three siblings

Finally determine, wether all the characters close relatives are still alive and healthy:

	Status
-4	both parents dead
-3	mother or father dead
-2	sibling died in accident or violent event
-1	sibling injured (disabled) (accident, violence or by birth)
0 to +4	all alive and kicking

3.3 EARLY LIFE EVENTS

Roll D4 to determine how many. Then roll D20 to decide which or draw a "Early Life Events"-Card (see appendix).

	Event
1	Childhood: almost died / accident
2	Childhood: childhood disease
3	Childhood: imaginary friend
4	Childhood: pet gained
5	Childhood: witnessed a crime

Event	
6	Childhood: pet lost
7	Teenager: bullied
8	Teenager: crime committed / accused
9	Teenager: made friend for life
10	Teenager: run away from home
11	Teenager: natural desaster survivor
12	Teenager: kicked out of school
13	Young Adult: became a parent
14	Young Adult: encountered a monster
15	Young Adult: made enemy for life
16	Young Adult: religious experience
17	Young Adult: left home
18	Young Adult: travelled abroad
19	Young Adult: saved a life
20	Young Adult: inherited an artifact



3.4 ADVANTAGES, DISADVANTAGES, QUIRKS

You can spent rl-xps to get advantages. Choosing disadvantages allows you the get rl-xps. You can choose up to three advantages and up to three disadvantages. Choose advantages and disadvantages only once during character backstory creation.

Advantage	Cost
Animal Empathy	3
Danger Sense	4
Adaptation to Low Light	4
Language Talent	3
Fearless	5
High Pain Treshold	3
Everybodys Darling	3
Savoir-faire	2
Storyteller	2
Collector of Things	2
Disadvantage	Cost
Bloodlust	1
Code of Honor	1
Curious	2
Honest, Cannot Lie	3
Intollerance (choose)	1
Jealousy	2
Obession (choose)	1
Impulsive	3
Phobia (choose)	1
Overconfidence	2

Quirks are minor disadvantages. Get .5 rl-xps for a quirk. Maximum of 2 quirks.

3.5 FINALIZE BACKSTORY

Regarding your Early Life Events, Advantages and Disadvantages, choose two Core Aspects for your character:

- Concept (positive aspect): "Who are you?"
- Complication (challenging aspect): "Waht's your problem?"

4. RECRUITMENT

4.1 ARX LUMINA SPECIFIC RULES

Consider the following points when playing in the arx lumina setting:

- The Character is part of a "Corpus Exploratori". Corpus Exploratori are squads of eight soldiers that explore the wild lands. They consist of a Commander, two Scouts, a Paramedic, three Soldiers and a Scientist or a Special Ops Member.
- The arx lumina setting uses a modified set of fate core skills.



List of the 17 arx lumina skills

- athletics (physique and dexterity challenges)
- burglary
- charisma
- deceive
- fight (meele weapons, choose one, others -2)
- first aid

- functional (artifact mastering)
- gamble
- leadership (organize, command)
- lore (also specialized lore: artifacts, mechanisms, history, species)
- notice (sensing unusual things or danger)
- shoot (ranged weapon, choose one; others -2)
- stealth
- supplies (how to find what you need)
- survival (how tough are you?)
- tactics (a good plan grants boni)
- will (challenges regarding discipline)

List of arx lumina military ranks

	Troops Rank	Command Rank
1	Recruit	Lieutenant
2	Lance Corporal	Captain
3	Corporal	Major
4	Lance Sergeant	Lt. Colonel
5	Sergeant	Colonel
6	Sergeant Major	General

4.2 ASSIGNMENT

The Character receives a basic training:

- +1 Fight
- +1 Survival

Afterwards he is assigned a role:

	Assignement	Starting Rank
-4	Scientist	Lieutenant
-3	Scientist	Sergeant
-2	Paramedic	Corporal
-1 to 0	Infantry	Recruit
+1	Support	Recruit
+2	Scout	Corporal
+3	Special Ops	Sergeant
+4	Special Ops	Lieutenant

5. MILITARY DUTY CYCLE

Player can choose to spend a rl-xp or to go on a virtual campaign. When spending an rl-xp, role on the following tables to determine the outcome of the duty cycle.

Handling of virtual campaigns is not covered in this quick reference. However, while improving skills when rolling on tables, the idea of virtual adventuring is, to get equipment, artifacts and real life coins (rl-coins). You can spend rl-coins on real things you like. This also closes the cycle **rl-xps > virtual roleplay > rl-coins**.

5.1 MISSION ASSIGNMENT

While most of the time is dumb military service, the mission stands for one memorable event in the duty cycle.

	Mission	Difficulty
1	Garrison Duty	Routine
2	Border Partol	Routine
3	Guard Duty	Routine
4	Training Camp	Routine
5	Supply Run	Routine
6	Reconnaissance	Standard
7	Escort Mission	Standard
8	Checkpoint Control	Standard
9	Search and Secure	Standard
10	Defensive Position	Standard
11	Assault	Dangerous
12	Ambush	Dangerous
13	Rescue Operation	Dangerous
14	Behind Enemy Lines	Dangerous
15	Demolition	Dangerous
16	Counter-Attack	Dangerous
17	Night Raid	Special Ops
18	Sabotage Mission	Special Ops
19	Extraction Under Attack	Special Ops
20	Last Stand	Special Ops

After determining the mission, roll on the specific mission table. Missions are grouped in Routine, Standard, Dangerous and Special Ops missions, with chances of getting wounded increasing.

When rolling "Class Skill+1" immediately roll on your assignment class table (see below).

ROUTINE MISSIONS (Low Risk)

1 - Garrison Duty

Maintain order and readiness at the home base.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4	Wounded	Unexpected enemy contact
-3 to -1	Gamble+1	Downtime activities with other soldiers
0	Notice+1	Constant awareness of base security
+1	Class Skill+1	Training in specialized role
+2 to +4	Tactics+1	Learning command procedures

2 - Border Patrol

Scout the perimeter and report any suspicious activity.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4	Wounded	Unexpected enemy contact
-3 to -1	Shoot+1	Contact with enemy scouts
0	Notice+1	Constant vigilance on patrol
+1	Supplies+1	Discovered cached resources
+2 to +4	Survival+1	Navigating difficult terrain

3 - Guard Duty

Watch over critical assets through the long hours.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -2	Nothing	Uneventful shift
-1	Gamble+1	Passing time between watches
0	Will+1	Mental discipline through tedium
+1	Class Skill+1	Equipment maintenance and training
+2 to +4	Notice+1	Constant vigilance during guard duty



4 - Training Exercise

Hone your skills in simulated combat scenarios.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -2	Tactics+1	Understanding battlefield coordination
-1	Survival+1	Reconnaissance training
0	Class Skill+1	Specialized role training
+1	Sneak+1	Undercover Ops training
+2 to +4	Burglary+1	Technical sabotage training

5 - Supply Run

Deliver essential supplies through contested routes.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4	Wounded	Ambushed during transport
-3 to -1	Shoot+1	Defending the convoy
0	Supplies+1	Successful delivery with surplus
+1	Survival+1	Navigation and route planning
+2 to +4	Decoration	Heroic delivery under fire

STANDARD MISSIONS (Medium Risk)

6 - Reconnaissance

Gather intelligence deep in enemy territory.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -3	Wounded	Discovered by enemy forces
-2 to -1	Survival+1	Operating in hostile environment
0	Notice+1	Observation and intelligence gathering
+1 to +2	Sneak+1	Avoiding enemy detection
+3 to +4	Decoration	Valuable intelligence gathered

7 - Escort Mission

Protect high-value targets during transport.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -3	Wounded	Taking fire to protect the asset
-2 to -1	Tactics+1	Coordinating convoy security
0	Shoot+1	Engaging threats to the convoy
+1 to +2	Will+1	Stress of protecting others
+3 to +4	Decoration	Saved VIP under heavy fire

8 - Checkpoint Control

Screen all traffic passing through your sector.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -3	Wounded	Suicide attack or ambush
-2 to -1	Will+1	Constant tension and decision-making
0	Notice+1	Screening and identifying threats
+1 to +2	Shoot+1	Engaging hostile vehicles
+3 to +4	Decoration	Prevented major incident

9 - Search and Secure

Clear buildings and establish control over the area.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -3	Wounded	Close quarters combat
-2 to -1	Sneak+1	Quiet building entry
0	Fight+1	Close quarters engagement
+1 to +2	Tactics+1	Coordinating room clearing
+3 to +4	Supplies+1	Discovered enemy cache

10 - Defensive Position

Hold a fortified position in hostile territory.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -3	Wounded	Extended combat engagement
-2 to -1	Tactics+1	Coordinating defensive fire
0	Shoot+1	Defensive marksmanship
+1 to +2	Will+1	Enduring sustained pressure
+3 to +4	Decoration	Held against overwhelming odds

DANGEROUS MISSIONS (High Risk)

11 - Assault

Storm enemy positions with overwhelming force.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -2	Wounded	Direct combat casualties
-1	Will+1	Courage under fire
0	Fight+1	Aggressive close combat
+1	Tactics+1	Coordinated assault
+2 to +4	Decoration	Heroism in the attack

12 - Ambush

Strike the enemy where they least expect it.

Outcome	Reasoning
---------	-----------

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -2	Wounded	Ambush turns into firefight
-1	Tactics+1	Planning and execution
0	Sneak+1	Setting up the ambush position
+1	Shoot+1	Initial engagement
+2 to +4	Decoration	Successful tactical execution

13 - Rescue Operation

Extract friendly forces from a hot zone.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -2	Wounded	Extracting casualties
-1	Class Skill+1	Medical/technical rescue skills
0	Will+1	Operating under extreme pressure
+1	Shoot+1	Fighting through to objective
+2 to +4	Decoration	Heroic rescue under fire

14 - Behind Enemy Lines

Operate isolated with no support or backup.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -2	Wounded	No medical support available
-1	Will+1	Psychological pressure of isolation
0	Survival+1	Self-sufficiency in hostile territory
+1	Sneak+1	Avoiding enemy patrols
+2 to +4	Decoration	Completing an impossible mission

15 - Demolition

Plant charges and destroy strategic targets.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -2	Wounded	Explosives mishap or enemy fire
-1	Shoot+1	Defending the demo team
0	Burglary+1	Technical skills with explosives
+1	Sneak+1	Infiltrating to target

	Outcome	Reasoning
+2 to +4	Decoration	Destroying critical target

16 - Counter-Attack

Push back an advancing enemy offensive.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -2	Wounded	Intense combat
-1	Shoot+1	Sustained firefight
0	Tactics+1	Coordinating the counter-offensive
+1	Will+1	Fighting from a disadvantage
+2 to +4	Decoration	Turning the tide of battle

SPECIAL OPERATIONS (Very High Risk)

17 - Night Raid

Strike under cover of darkness before dawn.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -1	Wounded	Darkness creates confusion
0	Sneak+1	Using darkness for concealment
+1 to +4	Decoration	Completing a high-value target mission

18 - Sabotage Mission

Infiltrate and cripple enemy infrastructure.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -1	Wounded	Discovery and pursuit
0	Burglary+1	Technical sabotage skills
+1 to +4	Decoration	Major strategic impact

19 - Extraction Under Fire

Fight your way to the evacuation point.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -1	Wounded	Running the gauntlet
0	Survival+1	Navigation under pressure

	Outcome	Reasoning
+1 to +4	Decoration	Getting everyone out alive

20 - Last Stand

Hold the line when retreat is no longer an option.

	Outcome	Reasoning
-4 to -1	Wounded	Facing overwhelming odds
0	Will+1	Courage facing certain death
+1 to +4	Decoration	Ultimate heroism or sacrifice

ASSIGNMENT- / RANK-TABLES

You can choose to roll on your assignment class table or on your rank table (Troops or Command).

Rank Table: Troops

	Outcome
-4 to -2	Survival+1
-1	Athletics+1
0	Fight+1
+1	Shoot+1
+2 to +4	Survival+1

Rank Table: Command

	Outcome
-4 to -2	Charisma+1
-1	Will+1
0	Tactics+1
+1	Leadership+1
+2 to +4	Charisma+1

Assignment Table: Scientist

	Outcome
-4 to -2	Lore: Species+1
-1	Notice+1

Outcome	
0	Lore:Mechanisms+1
+1	Lore:Artifacts+1
+2 to +4	Lore: History+1



Assignment Table: Paramedic

Outcome	
-4 to -2	Lore: Species+1
-1	Will+1
0	First Aid+1
+1	Survival+1
+2 to +4	Supplies+1

Assignment Table: Infantry

Outcome	
-4 to -2	Lore+1
-1	Gamble+1
0	Fight+1
+1	Shoot+1
+2 to +4	Lore+1

Assignment Table: Support

Outcome	
-4 to -2	Gamble+1
-1	Notice+1
0	Supplies+1
+1	Shoot+1
+2 to +4	Gamble+1

Assignment Table: Scout

Outcome	
-4 to -2	Burglary+1
-1	Notice+1
0	Stealth+1
+1	Lore: Mechanisms
+2 to +4	Burglary+1

Assignment Table: Special Ops

Outcome	
-4 to -2	Charisma+1
-1	Burglary+1
0	Stealth+1
+1	Deceive+1
+2 to +4	Charisma+1

5.2 CHARACTER LIFE EVENT

Roll a D20 or draw a "Main Life Events"-Card (see appendix) once per duty cycle to determine common events in the characters life.

	Event	Result (optional)
1	Severe Illness	Maybe skip next duty cycle or resign
2	Death of s.o. near	
3	End of Relationship	
4	Progression of Relationship	Marriage? Soulmates?
5	New Relationship	
6	New Contact	
7	Betrayed	Contact becomes Rival OR new rival
8	Bullied	New rival
9	Respected	Rival becomes contact OR new contact
10	Found Artifact	Roll on artifact table (below)
11	Got an admirer	New Contact / Romance
12	Got a "War Dog"	Accompanies on missions
13	Personal Protection from important Person	New extraordinary Contact
14	Birth of Child, Nice/Nephew or else	perhaps become godfather
15	S.o. owes you a favor	
16	You owe a favor to s.o.	Could be trigger for next mission
17	A friendly encounter with s.o. of another species	
18	A family member is plotting against you	What may be the cause of the plot?
19	S.o. teaches you a new skill	New Skill+1
20	Extraordinary Luck	Somthg. financial? A heritage? An artifact?

5.3 FINALIZE DUTY CYCLE

ASPECTS

A Character Life Event has a 20% Chance of generating an aspect in addition to the Concept and Complication already set. New Aspects alter in positive or challenging:

- 1st: concept (positive)
- 2nd: complication (challenging)
- 3rd: positive

- 4th: challenging
- 5th: military attribution
- 6th: positive
- 7th: challenging
- 8th: ...
- ...

The 5th aspect has to deal with the characters rank or situation in the corpus exploratori. This can deviate from the Character Life Event if the event is not suitable.

ARTIFACTS

Sometimes you get or find an artifact. Artifacts are replacements for stunts. Roll on table to determine the artifacts effect. Then choose an appropriate bonus or choose a skill randomly. If the character has not learned this skill yet, the character has now skill level 0.

	Skill / Effect	When
-4 to -2	Skill+1	permanent
-1	Skill+2	once per day
0	Skill+1	
+1	gain minor bonus	once per day
+2 to +4	gain major bonus	once per session

Finally describe the artifact: name, form, origin, how does it fit in the characters story?

PROMOTION

Roll once per duty cycle on the promotion table:

	Outcome
-4 to -1	Nothing happens
0	Decoration (Medal of Service)
+1	Promotion
+2 to +4	Promotion and Decoration (roll on table)

If you receive a decoration, roll on the following table:

	Outcome
-4 to -2	Medal of Service
-1 to 0	Medal of Distinct Service
+1 to +2	Medal of Bravery
+3 to +4	Grand Medal of the Holy Kingdom

6. ADVENTURING

6.1 BEFORE GOING ON A VIRTUAL ADVENTURE...

CLEAN-UP SKILL PYRAMIDE

Fate Core follows a strict rule for the skill pyramid. There must always be $x+1$ skills on the level below. Before going on an adventure, you have to ensure, that your skill pyramid fits the rule.

(GM-Hint: If you like you can allow Skill Pyramid Clean-Up any time, not only before going on adventure)

Clean-up is done "Tetris-Style":

- if not enough skills below: drop current skill one level, gain one skill-point.
- if skill-points left: raise skill by one level if possible. otherwise turn skill-point into rl-xp (DM-hint: change by a quota of 1:1 or whatever seems suitable for your campaign)



CLEAN-UP ASPECTS

If the character has more than five aspects:

- choose from all positive aspects (apart from concept) one as 3rd aspect. discard the others
- same with challenging aspects (apart from complication)

6.2 SOME THOUGHTS ON ADVENTURING

REWARDS

Session Rewards At the end of an adventure session the character gets - apart from virtual things like artefacts or else - a chest with real life coins (rl-coins). The player can use these rl-coins to get real life things as a reward for his activities that earned him rl-xps.

(GM-Hint: Determine an exchange rate rl-coins to currency that suits best.)

Campaign Rewards Adventuring is most likely organized in a Campaign, where one session builds upon the previous. So there is an overall Goal to pursue and maybe an overall reward to claim in the end. A Campaign Reward can be an invitation from the quest giver for a special event or a special present.

NARRATIVE PROGRESSION

Aspects

- Get a new (positive or negative) Aspect (clean-up before next adventure)
- Modify Concept or Complication, but only if Adventure alters Characters Beliefs or Situation fundamentally
- Modify another existing aspect, maybe drop it ("That's no longer me") (clean-up before next adventure, especially when negative turns to positive or vice versa)
- Merge two aspects to get a stronger one (e.g. "Friend of Animals" + "Survivalist" → "Master of the Wild"). Yields an "EPIC" aspect. (Max. of 1 epic aspects per character. This should be a character lifetime achievement.)

Other Attributes

- Does the Character acquire a new Quirk?
- Does the Character acquire a new Rival, Enemy, Contact or Friend?
- Anything else to add to Character Backstory?

FATE POINTS

Refresh Fate Points at the End of Adventure. Refresh Rate is +3. This remains constant unless altered by an artifact (e.g. "The Ring of Fate (refresh+1)")

7. APENDIX

7.1 GM TIP: NARRATIVE PROGRESSION

ASPECTS TRANSFORMATION

Facilitate Discussion:

- "Which aspect feels like it changed during this campaign?"
- "What did your character learn about themselves?"
- "Which aspect no longer fits who they've become?"

GET NEW Is Default:

- Safer than Modify/Drop/Merge
- Always narratively justified

MODIFY/DROP Needs Justification:

- Campaign must have addressed the Aspect
- Player should WANT the change
- Makes sense only after character growth arc

MERGE Is Rare:

- Save for major, campaign-ending moments
- Should feel legendary, not routine
- Maximum 1 Epic Aspect per character ever

GM-TIP: WHAT IS AN APPROPRIATE CAMPAIGN REWARD?

- Discuss early what "appropriate" means
- Consider campaign length (3 sessions vs. 20 sessions)
- Focus on "treat yourself" not "break the bank"

Examples by Campaign Length:

Short (3-5 sessions): Book, game, nice meal
Medium (6-12 sessions): Gaming gear, weekend trip, hobby equipment
Long (13+ sessions): Major purchase, special event, significant treat